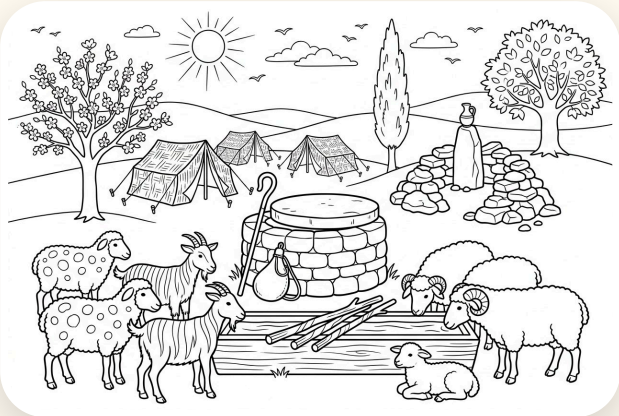
It Really Happened

A Thought on Parashat Vayetze

Dvar Torah - a printable page



Dear children, in this week's parasha the Torah tells us that Yaakov Avinu goes out to Charan, and there he has to deal with Lavan, who tricks him again and again. In last week's parasha we saw how Yaakov bought the birthright from Esav, and even so, he had to dress up as Esav to receive the brachos.

We know that Yaakov is the man of truth. So how can it be that all his life, people keep trying to lie to him and trick him?

The answer is that a person's tests come exactly where things are hard for him, and that is where a person is really measured. For example, it's no big deal to be polite when everyone around you speaks nicely to you. The real test is to stay calm, without getting angry, when everyone around us is making us upset.

Yaakov Avinu is the man of truth precisely because of all the lies that chased after him. If everyone around him had been people of truth, he could never have discovered the power of truth that was inside him.

Of course, we must never walk into tests on purpose. But the tests we do go through are there to help us grow. If our lives worked out perfectly, everything would be ordinary, and there would be no room to grow. But the more tests we meet and manage to pass, the stronger we become spiritually.

That is why Yaakov Avinu had to be chased by lies, because that is exactly what gave him the strength to rise to great and special heights.

Shabbat Shalom, and a blessed one!